The Five Whys

Team Name	Digital Transformation and Operations Team
Problem Statement	Loan application approvals take 3 to 5 business days, causing an 80% customer drop-off rate.

	Why	This happened because:	Is this the root cause?
1	Why do approvals take 3 to 5 business days?	Because the manual operations queue experiences a 48-hour backlog reviewing bank statement PDFs.	No
2	Why is there a 48-hour backlog in manual reviews?	Because operations agents must manually open, inspect, and cross-check every uploaded PDF line-by-line.	No
3	Why must agents inspect every PDF line-by-line manually?	Because the system cannot automatically extract and validate financial data from uploaded documents	No
4	Why can't the system automatically extract data?	Because the legacy mobile app lacks an integrated OCR (Optical Character Recognition) parsing service	No
5	Why is there no integrated OCR service?	Because the platform was built on legacy software that relies entirely on manual back-office processing.	Yes

Action Plan

#	Owner	Action	Status
1	Lead BA/ Lead Architect	Design API Gateway architecture to de-couple legacy backend from mobile frontend.	
2	Fintech Integration Lead	Evaluate and procure third-party OCR API software for automated bank statement parsing	
3	QA / Product Lead	Conduct end-to-end integration testing and setup automated push notification microservices.	
4			
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